Name: .....
ID: .....

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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
E304B
Exploring English Grammar (II)
All Branches
Makeup MTA Exam

2025-2026 / Fall
Date: 3 Dec. 2025
12:00 – 2:00

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 12 (Including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

1. Allow approximately 10 minutes to read the instructions on this page and to read through the whole examination paper.

2. There are TWO parts to this MTA examination paper:

Part A (20 marks): There are FOUR practical questions. You are required to answer all FOUR questions.

Part B (10 marks): There are TWO essay questions. You are required to answer only ONE.

3. Carefully follow the instructions in each part.

4. In your answer, make sure that you:

- Write the number of the question that you decide to answer.

- Cross out any rough notes you make that you do not wish to be marked/graded.

5. Review your answers carefully, paying attention to your grammar, spelling, and punctuation as well as to relevant textual elements (e.g., paragraphing, cohesion & coherence), as part of the mark for each question will be given to language accuracy and text organization

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PART A

Answer ALL FOUR Questions (20 marks)

Question 1:

The noun groups (NGs) below all involve one or more postmodifiers. Circle the head noun (HN) and underline the postmodifiers in each Noun Group. Then, **identify the form** of each postmodifier *as a prepositional group, a finite embedded clause, and/or a non-finite embedded clause.*

(5 marks; each circled HN and underlined postmodifier = 0.5 mark and each label = 0.5 mark)

1. a framework for understanding cultural differences in business contexts

2. the hypothesis proposed in the recent journal article

3. an experiment measuring reaction times under different conditions

4. the professor whose research focuses on AI applications in education

5. a report on the effects of social media on mental health

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Question 2:

Each of the following clauses has different types of lexical cohesion indicated by the words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of lexical cohesion for each as:

- **Repetition** (same word repeated)
- **Antonymy** (words with opposite meanings)
- **Synonymy** (words with similar meanings)
- **Meronymy** (part-whole relationship)
- **Co-meronymy** (two words that are parts of the same whole)
- **Hyponymy** (specific term related to a general category)
- **Co-hyponymy** (two or more words that fall under the same category)

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. The **cat** licked its **paw**, while the **dog** wagged its **tail**.

_____

2. The manager praised the team for their **dedication**, and the director appreciated their **commitment**.

_____

3. The classroom contained **desks**, **chairs**, and **whiteboards**.

_____

4. **Apples**, **oranges**, and **bananas** are rich in vitamins.

_____

5. He walked **quickly** through the hallway, while she ran at **full speed**.

_____

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Question 3:

Each of the following clauses has different types of grammatical cohesion indicated by the words/phrases in bold. Write the type of grammatical cohesion for each as: ***text connector, anaphoric reference, cataphoric reference, noun substitution, verb substitution, clause substitution, or ellipsis.***

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. The assistant checked the references, and the editor **did** too.

_____

2. The lecturer distributed the handouts, and the students read them carefully.

_____

3. She wanted to order the salad, but I chose the same **one**.

_____

4. If you need clarification, the syllabus says so on page 12.

_____

5. The candidate promised to improve facilities, **but** she failed to do so after being elected.

_____

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Question 4:

Underline the theme(s) in the following clauses and identify each as **marked or unmarked**.

(5 marks: underlining theme(s) = 0.5 mark and labelling the theme(s) = 0.5)

1. The research methodology was clearly explained in the second chapter.

2. After years of debate, the policy was finally implemented.

3. The case study illustrates how cultural factors influence communication.

4. Across different disciplines, the concept of critical thinking is applied differently.

5. The findings of this survey highlight gaps in current knowledge.

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PART B
Two Writing Questions
Answer ONLY ONE (10 marks)

Question 1:

Write an extended definition paragraph for FOUR of the following terms (70-100 words) in which you define, explain, and discuss the following grammatical terms and concepts clearly and fully as they are discussed in the relevant course unit materials. Support your answers with relevant examples to illustrate your understanding, using your own words. ***(10 marks)***

1. Zigzag Pattern ***(2.5 marks)***
2. Presenting Reference ***(2.5 marks)***
3. Channel ***(2.5 marks)***
4. Grammatical metaphor ***(2.5 marks)***
5. Coherence ***(2.5 marks)***

Question 2:

Read the text below carefully to establish its overall context and do the following tasks:

Task (1): The first paragraph (i.e., the macro-theme) in the text is missing. Following the text, there are three sample macro-themes. Select the one that best highlights the ideas communicated by the writer. *(1 mark)*

Task (2): Write an essay (300-350 words) in which you discuss the following:

- theme-rheme at the clause level *(1 mark)*
- hyper-themes and their role in text organization *(2 marks)*
- thematic progression patterns in the text *(4 marks)*
- justification for the chosen macro-theme *(2 marks)*

Your answer should be comprehensive, clear, and focused. Illustrate your answers with appropriate examples from the given text. Use your own words.

Possible macro-themes:
(a) The role of social media in education is complex, balancing its benefits for connectivity and career development with its challenges related to distraction and well-being.
(b) Social media significantly influences university students' academic and personal lives, offering opportunities for learning and networking but also creating risks to focus and mental health.
(c) The growing use of social media has revolutionized communication and learning among university students, requiring institutions to provide proper guidance.

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The Impact of Social Media on University Students

FIRST PARAGRAPH IS MISSING HERE

Social media platforms have become an integral part of university students' daily lives. They are used for communication, information sharing, and academic collaboration, making them a powerful tool for both personal and professional development.

One of the positive impacts of social media is its ability to connect students across geographical boundaries. Online groups and forums allow learners from different cultural and academic backgrounds to exchange ideas and resources, enriching their educational experiences.

Social media also provides students with opportunities for professional networking. Platforms such as LinkedIn enable students to showcase their skills, connect with employers, and gain insights into potential career paths. This networking can be particularly valuable in bridging the gap between education and employment.

However, the use of social media also carries risks. Excessive engagement can lead to procrastination, distraction, and reduced academic performance. Furthermore, constant exposure to curated online images can affect students' mental health, leading to anxiety and lowered self-esteem.

Universities have a responsibility to guide students in using social media productively. By integrating digital literacy programs and offering workshops, institutions can help students maximize the benefits of social media while minimizing its potential harm.

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